PART II · TIME · 3
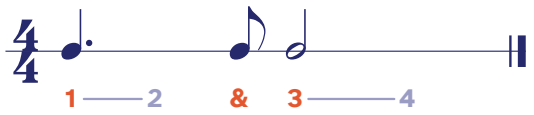
How long is a note?

Need a note longer than its shape allows? Two signs stretch it: the **dot**, which adds half, and the **tie**, which glues two notes into one sound.

THE SECRET
A dot adds half. A tie glues two notes into one.

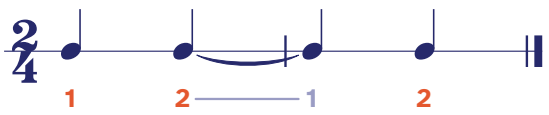
The dot

A dot adds **half the note's value**: a dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 = 3 beats; a dotted crotchet 1 + ½ = 1½. A **double dot** adds half, then a quarter: a double-dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 + ½ = 3½.



The tie

A curve joining two notes **of the same pitch** makes one longer sound: play the first, hold through the second. Ties can cross a bar line, where a dot cannot.
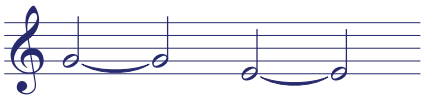


The dot, in pizzas

The dot is a helper that adds **half of whatever its note is worth**. Dark slices: the note. Lighter: what the dot adds. Lightest: a second dot, half of the first dot.

dotted minim		2 + **1** (half of 2) = **3 beats**
dotted crotchet		1 + **½** (half of 1) = **1½ beats**
dotted quaver		½ + **¼** (half of ½) = **¾ beat**
double-dotted minim		2 + **1** + ½ = **3½ beats**

Tie or slur?



Tie: the same pitch. Play once and hold: G for 4 beats, then E for 4.

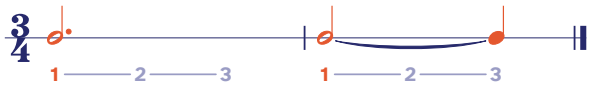


Slur: different pitches. Play every note, smoothly joined (legato).

PART II · TIME · 3 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

Dot or tie: which is longer?
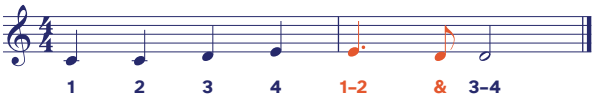


1. **The dotted minim:** 2 + half of 2 = 3 beats.
2. **The tied notes:** a minim tied to a crotchet, 2 + 1 = 3 beats.
3. **Play both:** one sound, held for three beats.

They are **the same length**. A tie can also cross a bar line, which a dot cannot.

EXAMPLE 2

A dotted crotchet you already know: Ode to Joy



1. **Bars 3–4 of Beethoven's Ode to Joy.** Sing it: "C C D E, E — D D".
2. **The red E is a dotted crotchet:** 1 + ½ = 1½ beats, held through "1 & 2".
3. **The quaver D** falls on the "&" of beat 2; the last D takes beats 3 and 4.

Long–short, then long: the dot is why the tune **leans** before it lands.

EXAMPLE 3

Which is longer: a dotted minim or a minim tied to a quaver?



1. **Dotted minim:** 2 + 1 = 3 pizzas.
2. **Minim tied to a quaver:** 2 + ½ = 2½ pizzas.
3. **Compare:** 3 is half a beat more than 2½.

The **dotted minim** is longer, by half a beat.

THINK OF IT A tie couples two carriages: the passenger stays seated across the join, even over a bar line. A dot cannot cross the bar line.

TRAP

- ✕ Putting the dot on the wrong note: a dot adds half of **its own** note.
- ✕ Tying two different pitches: that curve is a slur, not a tie.

SEE ALSO

Time signatures p. 41 · Rhythm p. 45

PRACTISE IT

Workbook Level 0 · Note values · Online: Library › Notes and rests